Definition:

"The managerial control implies the measurement of accomplishment against the standard and the correction of deviation to assure attainment of objectives according to plans". Koontz and O'Donnell

In the words of G.R. Terry, "Controlling is the determining what is being accomplished that is evaluating the performance and, if necessary, applying corrected measures so that the performance takes place according to plan".

Concepts of Control:

Control is a fundamental and managerial function that usually follows other functions. But like planning and other functions, control is also a continuing process of management. More than any other functions; control becomes intimately connected to planning and has the same characteristics of unity, continuity, flexibility and pervasiveness as are present in planning. Controlling as a function of management, therefore, means the measurement and correction of performance of activities of subordinates in order to make sure that enterprise objectives, and the plans devised to attain them are accomplished.

9.3 Objectives of Controlling

The main objectives of controlling is to check and ensure the performance of work is in accordance with the plans.

1. **To make the plans more effective:** Managers have to plan properly to measure the progress and get feedback to direct them to do the work effectively.
2. **To make organisations effective:** Any organisation needs control for achieving its goals and objectives.
3. **To help in Decision Making:** The ultimate purpose of control is to help managers for taking better decision. Control gives awareness to the managers regarding the problem and give necessary information for making decisions.
4. **To apply corrective measures:** Control helps to find out the deviations from the actual and help to take corrective actions because of this measures mistakes can be prevented.
5. **To maximize the utilization of resources:** Control helps to utilise the men, material and machinery to the maximum to attain the goal and avoid misuse of resources.
6. **To motivate employees:** Controlling helps to motivate the employees and make the employees to work with dedication.
7. **To fix responsibility:** The objective of control is to determine the authorities and fix the responsibilities of the employees regarding their work performance.
8. **To face the challenging environment:** Business environment changes often and the plans must be changed accordingly. This changes can be known with the help of control and necessary changes are made in plans.

9.4 Characteristics of Control

The following are the important characteristics of Control function

1. **Controlling is an estimation:** A manager can take corrective actions/ steps only about future operations.

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